

Game Design Document: BananaMan the Crystal Peel (Working Title)

1. Game Overview

Title: Banana Quest (Working Title)

Genre: 2.5D Platformer / Collectathon

Platforms: PC, Nintendo Switch, PS5, Xbox Series X

Target Audience: Ages 8–30; fans of whimsical platformers, nostalgic gamers, and indie game collectors

High Concept: A surreal platforming journey that combines fruit-themed lands where Banana Man must collect Juice Shards and restore flavor to the Fruit Kingdom.

2. Narrative

Setting: The Fruit Kingdom – a whimsical realm made of fantastical environments themed after fruits. Each region has its own biome and guardian.

Main Character: Banana Man – a heroic, agile banana in sneakers and gloves, armed with a boomerang-like peel and strong arms.

Story Premise: A flavor-stealing force called "The Rot" is leeching the essence from the Fruit Kingdom. Guided by the mystical Pineapple Oracle, Banana Man embarks on a quest to retrieve the stolen Juice Shards.

Progression: Five regions must be restored by collecting Juice Shards and defeating corrupted fruit guardians. Between levels, the story unfolds with comic-style cutscenes and whimsical dialogues.

3. Gameplay Mechanics

Core Loop:

Explore themed levels

Collect Juice Shards and hidden items

Unlock abilities and paths

Player Abilities:

Jump / Double Jump

//Peel Glide (slow fall)

Banana Projectile

//Banana Boomerang (ranged attack + collect distant items)

Banana Punch //(melee combo attack)

TODO Combat System:

Combine punch combos and banana boomerangs

Use throwables for high damage or solving environmental puzzles

Enemies drop Fruit Tokens and sometimes health

Collectables:

Juice Shards (primary objective, 5–7 per level)

Fruit Tokens //(used to unlock cosmetics, mini-games, and concept art)

Flavor Seeds //(used to activate upgrades in the hub world)

Power-Ups:

Temporary forms (e.g., Runner Mode for speed/collectable marathon, Coconut Armor for defense)

Juice Meter: fills up during combat; activates temporary Juice Rush Mode (increased speed, auto-reflect boomerang, invincibility)

4. Level Design & Progression

Level Types:

Platforming stages: large, interconnected 2.5D levels with side paths

//Puzzle rooms/mini games: focus on using throwables and switches

//Combat arenas: defend against waves of fruit monsters

//Secret stages: bonus content unlocked with Fruit Tokens

World Themes:

Sunny Orchard - Bright cheerful fruit field with green grass and trees, Mountain level visible in distance.

Citrus Swamp – Dark gloomy fruit filled swamp/bog with a heavy fog overlay

Banana Boulder Heights - Giant circular mountain with falling hazards and planks that wind to ascending the peak.

//Hub World: Fruit Square

//Interactable NPCs (fruit-themed characters)

//Upgrade trees and Juice Shard monuments

//Mini-game kiosk and arcade machine

//Cosmetic vendor with alternate banana costumes

5. Art & Visuals

Visual Style: Stylized, saturated colors with a dreamlike quality; chunky and expressive character models

Camera: 2.5D with dynamic angles during special sequences for collectable run feature or boss fights, death animations, teleportation events and switching between spline path side orientation and classic 3rd person.

Animation Style: Most Similar to Pepsi Man(PS1)

UI:

Health displayed as floating hearts

Canvas bottom bar with collectable display

Collection counters and power-up icons in the corners

Menu and map UI inspired by Mystical Ninja and Klonoa with playful, bouncing icons

6. Sound & Music

Music Style:

//Tropical instruments upbeat (steel drums, marimbas) in first level

//Boss music: funky, energetic, with percussion and fruit-themed motifs

//Sound Effects:

Punches with comedic 'whomp' sounds

Boomerang whooshes

Fruit Collectables make squish sounds whereas Gems make a chimey high pitched ring

Voice Snippets:

Banana Man: “That’s bananas!”

Enemies have cartoon-style grunts and squeaks

7. Enemies & Bosses

Enemy Types:

//Fruit Flies – fast, divebombing pests

//Rotten Bats – swarm in dark caverns

Moldy Munchers – chase the player //and explode on contact

Juice Leeches – steal your Juice Meter charge

Archer/Laser fruit Henchmen - Fire lasers or singular projectiles either homing or not

//Final Boss:

Rotten Raspberry – a oversized slow, sloppy shadowy mold-beast trying to steal BananaMans life essence(Potassium)

8. UI/UX

HUD Elements:

Heart-based Health

//Juice Metering

//Collectable Tracker (on pause screen and end-of-level screen)

GEMS

Menus:

//Fruit-themed tabs

//Stage select map with character path and unlockable cutscenes

Accessibility:

//Button remapping

//Subtitles and voice cues

High-contrast mode

9. Technical Details

Engine: Unity with URP or (2.5D camera)

Resolution: Target 720-p, 30fps

Save System: Autosave between stages; manual saves in hub world

Tools Used: Blender (3D assets), Aseprite (UI mockups), FMOD (audio integration)

10. Production Plan

Milestone Roadmap:

Dynamic Camera switching/Movement

Movement + Combat Prototype (Punch, Jump/DoubleJump Boomerang, Throw)

All Basic Platforming abilities

All Basic Enemy types implemented and Eventually animated

Collectables + collectable display in HUD

Citrus Swamp prototype level + UI mockups

BananaRunner Segment/functionality

Level polishing/ design layout of assets

Testing, optimization, full cutscene integration